HARSHAL SARAOGI

Product Manager | AI-Native Builder-PM | Enterprise SaaS, Cloud Commerce & AI Platforms
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SUMMARY

Product Manager with 5+ years across enterprise SaaS, cloud commerce, and AI platforms, currently owning the Telco SaaS and AI-platform product lines at Paytm. **I build what I spec:** I design, prototype, and ship production-grade enterprise platforms end to end using an agentic AI workflow (Claude Code, Cursor, Codex) that covers market research, PRDs, UX, Node.js/Next.js code, Jira and Confluence, QA, and deployment — then hire and lead the engineering teams that scale them. Three such platforms (TravelDesk, HRMS, BSS) are in UAT or active development at a 50,000-employee organisation. PG in AI & Machine Learning, IIIT Bangalore.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Paytm (One97 Communications) • Noida, India **Jul 2025 – Present**

Product Manager I — Telco SaaS, Cloud Commerce & AI Platforms (Apr 2026 – Present)

Associate Product Manager (Jul 2025 – Mar 2026) — promoted to PM I in 9 months

- Own product strategy, technical scoping, and delivery for Paytm Telco SaaS initiatives — Cloud Commerce, Business Support System (BSS), TravelDesk, HRMS, and the AI Operations platform — from discovery through release, working with engineering, infosec, finance, HR, and senior management.
- Run an agentic product workflow in which every initiative moves from market research → PRD → UX design → working Node.js/Next.js prototype → Jira epics/stories and Confluence specs → QA/UAT, with Claude Code, Cursor, and Codex as the primary build tools; working prototypes, not slide decks, are the alignment artifact for leadership and engineering.
- Lead execution for 16+ engineers across Kanban streams: Jira project setup, acceptance criteria, release trackers, daily unblocking, infosec review gates, and go-live planning.
- Lead technical scoping across API contracts, data models, service boundaries, NFRs, cloud deployment, and performance/security requirements; define QA coverage and UAT readiness for each release.
- Scoped the AI Operations platform — chatbots, digital avatars, IVR journeys, bot configuration, conversation orchestration, RBAC, analytics/reporting, and third-party integrations — and initiated evaluation of locally hosted Small Language Models and OCR pipelines for document processing, targeting lower inference cost, data privacy, and reduced dependency on external LLM APIs.

Flagship product builds at Paytm — designed, prototyped, and delivered end to end with an agentic AI workflow

TravelDesk — Corporate Travel & Expense Reimbursement Platform — *conceived, architected, and built solo; in organisational UAT, Phase-1 production rollout targeted Jan 2027*

- Authored the 116-page master PRD covering travel requests, multi-level approvals, booking coordination, expense claims, OCR receipt capture, policy validation, reimbursement workflow, notifications, and admin controls; consolidated ~94 source stories into 56 Jira-ready stories across 10 epics.
- Designed an 18-microservice architecture (Next.js frontend, Spring Boot API gateway, 16 domain services), multi-tenant from day one, integrated with PeopleStrong (HRIS), Quest2Travel, and SAP.
- Built and deployed the MVP myself with AI-assisted development; now leading a six-engineer post-MVP team (2 backend, 2 frontend, 2 QA) working agentically, with a mobile web app and Phase-2 integrations (EBIX forex, Recharge) scoped and sequenced around infosec review gates.

HRMS — In-house Human Resource Management System — *PeopleStrong replacement for ~50,000 employees; scoping and prototyping*

- Authored a 461-page, 13-module PRD benchmarked against Workday, Darwinbox, and PeopleStrong; led a fresh market study across 12+ vendors (Keka, greytHR, ZingHR, Zoho, Rippling, HiBob, BambooHR, Deel) to close scope for a modular, multi-tenant ecosystem designed to be productised beyond Paytm.
- Scoped India compliance end to end (PF, ESI, PT, LWF, TDS, gratuity, Labour Codes, DPDP Act); gap analysis identified Performance Management as the critical-path module blocking Compensation Planning.
- Co-defined the target architecture with engineering — modular-monolith core (Postgres, schema-per-module, transactional outbox, event bus) plus five satellite services (notifications, document generation, payroll vendor adapter, AI assistant, analytics) — and generated a configurable Configuration Engine and the “Obsidian Command” design system via Codex; UI prototype covers the core HR flows.

BSS — Telco Business Support System — *in active development*

- Designed the complete product and UX, built the working Node.js prototype, and set up the Jira and Confluence workspace; personally delivered ~60% of the build from local development through deployment, then hired and onboarded a dedicated engineering team to take it forward.

Cloud Commerce — SaaS prototype for SAP-to-cloud migration (Paytm Telco) — *prototype delivered*

- Built an 8-module working Node.js prototype in Cursor within 3 months; scoped 100+ APIs and integration touchpoints, service boundaries, and admin/product modules — cutting ~1 month of downstream discovery/build effort and becoming the reference design for the migration strategy.

Hippo Innovations • Gurugram, India **Dec 2023 – Jul 2025**

Senior Project Associate — Product Development

- Translated 50+ business use cases into PRDs, user journeys, and roadmaps for 5+ cloud products (AWS and Google Cloud) built with React, Node.js, Angular, and Vue.js engineering teams.
- Owned cross-functional delivery from discovery to launch and introduced structured QA/UAT gates ahead of releases; ran backlog refinement, sprint planning, and stakeholder reviews in Jira, Asana, and Trello.
- Primary product contact for enterprise storefront clients including Amul and SBI Life; received written client commendations for proactive support and issue resolution.

ANS Commerce (Flipkart Group) • Gurugram, India **Sep 2022 – Dec 2023**

Senior Associate Project Manager — Product Development (Jun 2023 – Dec 2023)

Associate Project Manager — Web Applications & Product Delivery (Sep 2022 – May 2023) — promoted in 9 months

- Led roadmap execution, feature prioritisation, and cross-functional delivery for the in-house commerce platforms Kartify and Flipshop.
- Authored PRDs for high-impact integrations and client programmes — Shop by Color, MoEngage, Bose, ITC Fiama D2C, and Ekart Logistics — translating customer requirements into technical execution plans; managed each from ideation to launch and in-market iteration.
- Established delivery visibility through Jira and Confluence, enabling predictable launches and stronger stakeholder alignment; recognised in writing by ITC, Ekart, and Alma Mater stakeholders.

AdsRole • Noida, India **Jun 2021 – May 2022**

Assistant Manager — Product Delivery & Web Projects

- Directed 20+ concurrent client product and web programmes with 98% on-time completion, defining scope, milestones, QA checkpoints, and client acceptance criteria.
- Allocated designers, developers, content, analytics, and QA resources across projects and led weekly client calls with US, UK, and Australian stakeholders.

SKILLS

- **Product:** Discovery, market research, MVP scoping, PRDs/BRDs, roadmaps, user journeys, user stories, acceptance criteria, prioritisation, launch planning, stakeholder governance
- **Technical:** System design, API design and contracts, data modelling, microservices and modular monoliths, NFRs, AWS, GCP, SAP-to-cloud migration, OCR pipelines, local SLMs
- **AI-native build:** Claude Code, Cursor, OpenAI Codex, prompt engineering, agentic development workflows, Node.js, Next.js, JavaScript, Python, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL
- **Delivery and tools:** Jira, Confluence, Figma, Kanban and Scrum, QA/UAT, release management, infosec review gates, GA4, GTM

EDUCATION

PG Program in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning — IIIT Bangalore **Nov 2023 – Aug 2025**

Bachelor of Computer Applications — Asian School of Business, Noida **Aug 2019 – Apr 2022**

Selected certifications: Foundations of Project Management (Google); Python for Data Science (IBM); Executive Certification in Cloud Computing (NIIT); ISO/IEC 27001 Information Security Associate (SkillFront); Google Analytics 360

CLIENT RECOGNITION

Written commendations from stakeholders at ITC (Fiama), Amul, Ekart (Flipkart), SBI Life, and Alma Mater for ownership, responsiveness, and delivery under tight timelines — harshalsaraogi.com/testimonials